



Resident Evil Reboot

Johannes Roberts' Resident Evil Reboot has wrapped up filming; expected to release on September 2021. <http://digit.in/jan21-35>



Ready Player Two Movie

Ernest Cline, author of "Ready Player" series of books reveals that a sequel to the 2018 film is in the works. <http://digit.in/jan21-36>

in its feeds that attempted to pre-bunk any fake news that could be related to the polling and results. The messages contained links to sites where the users could get more information. We definitely need some Minority Report style technology that can predict and warn of specific types of fake news, preferably based on AI instead of metahuman slaves.



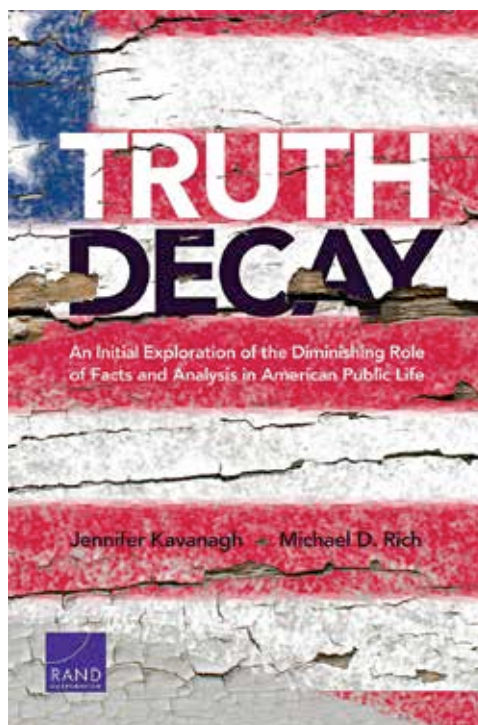
POLITAINMENT

When it comes to consumption of content, there is a blurring of traditional genres. Music channels now show movies, movie channels have talk shows, and general entertainment channels have been replaced by news channels, so the emergence of politainment should be no surprise at all. This is where a politically charged news item is shown in a dramatic manner, with reenactment, striking visuals, and over the top metaphoric language. For the politicians it is a way of crowd manipulation and drumming up support while the news channels want to capture the eyeballs of those favouring certain political views so this is technically a win for everyone involved, including the anti-intellectualist intended audience. So where does one go to get the news? Probably a comedy show on one of the last remaining general entertainment channels.



DRAGGING SITE

Dragging sites or trashing sites are transient and temporary internet forums that are churned out by the internet h8 machine, with a group of people focused on making a specific person's life miserable. They may be a journalist, or an influencer or even a small business owner. The people on the sites track their every move, and then start harassing the targets in various ways. This can include reporting fake crimes to the law enforcement officials, seeding baseless rumours to gossip publications, review bombing the properties or content of the



The book is published by Rand corporation and is available for free online.

targets, along with stalking and hate speech. Those who are on the receiving end can be overwhelmed, and are not really slebs (the cool, new and easier to write word for celebs) to handle the attention, and have posted publicly on how dragging sites or trashing sites can adversely affect their mental health. At times the harassment can extend to friends and family members of the target as well. Essentially dragging sites are digital platforms that crowdsource abuse through cyberspace.



REVENGE SHOPPING

The first place in the world where the cities opened up after a period of lockdown to prevent further spread of the coronavirus, was China. The cooped up citizens went on some kind of a binge shopping spree, a form of retail therapy perhaps to cure the blues of being locked up. In fact, one high-end fashion store in China saw its highest single day sales ever, just after the lockdown was lifted. At that time, economists wondered if the people in

India would behave the same way. Most of the experts did not really believe that Indian consumers were very similar to the Chinese, and were of the opinion that India would not see an uptick in spending after the lifting of the lockdown. However, as the festival season came around and the ecommerce platforms started having sales, the millennials at least resorted to some revenge shopping during the phases of the lifting of restrictions. For example, after months of eating home cooked food, they began to order more deliveries. By all indications, yes Indians did seek out the retail therapy, but just did not wait for the lockdown to lift, and instead splurged what they could online. A win for the ecommerce platforms at least.



COLD CHAIN

This section of the magazine cannot really be complete without a new word or phrase introduced by the pandemic. The latest addition to the ronaspreek glossary is the "cold chain" which is the supply chain including the logistics and equipment needed to keep vaccines frozen from the point of production till the point of delivery. Officials in India too have been holding meetings to discuss setting up the cold chain infrastructure needed for a widespread rollout of vaccines. The vaccines closest to mass deployment such as the ones developed by Pfizer in partnership with BioNTech or the one developed by Moderna, are all RNA based vaccines, and need to be transported and stored at sub zero temperatures to remain viable. The former needs to be at -70 degrees Celsius, and the latter at -20 degrees Celsius. While there are only a few facilities that can handle the ultracold storage, there are quite a few that can handle a cold chain. 